Eva Braun: Tea for Two and Two For Tea

By W.D. Snodgrass

Lines in italics should be sung to the tune Two for Tea: See the following link to hear the song:
http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y0zc7x434Aw

INTRODUCTION

Hitler's mistress, Eva Braun, received no public recognition and often felt badly neglected. Her small revenges included singing American songs, her favorite being "Tea for Two." Having to chosen to die with Hitler in his safety bunker in April of 1945 as the American Troops advanced across Europe, she appeared quite serene during the last days. This poem explores the possible thoughts of Eva Braun as she prepares for her death. Eva Braun: Tea for Two and Two for Tea by W.D. Snodgrass.

Tea for two
And two for tea

I ought to feel ashamed

Feeling such joy. Behaving like a spoiled child!

4NG Fanatics

So fulfilled. This is a very serious matter.

All of them have come here to die. And they grieve.

I have come here to die. If this is dying,

Why else did I ever live?

Me for you
And you for me

We ought to never flaunt our good luck

In the face of anyone less fortunate --

These live fools mourning already

For their own deaths: these dead fools

Who believe they can go on living . . .

And you for me
Alone.

Who out of all of them, officers, ministers,

These liars that despise me, these empty

Women that envy me -- so they hate me –

Who else of them dares to disobey Him

As I dared? I have defied Him to His face

And He has honored me.

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We will raise
A family

They sneer at me – at my worrying about

Frau Goebbels' children, that I make fairytales

For them, that we play at war. Is our war

More lost if I console these poor trapped rabbits?

These children He would not give me . . .

A boy for you
A girl for me

They sneer that I should bring

Fine furniture down this dank hole. Speer

Built this bed for me. Where I have slept

Beside our Chief. Who else should have it?

My furs, my best dress to my little sister --

They would sneer even at this; yet

What else can I give her?

Can't you see
How happy we would be?

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Or to the baby

She will bear Fegelein? Lechering dolt!

Well, I have given her her wedding

As if it was my own. And she will have

My diamonds, my watch. The little things you

Count on, things that see you through your

Missing life, the life that stood you up.

Nobody near us
To see us or hear us

I have it all. They are all gone, the others --

The Valkyrie; and the old rich bitch Bechstein;

Geli above all. No, the screaming mobs above all.

They are all gone now. He has left them all.

No one but me and the love-struck secretaries --

Traudl, Daran – who gave up years ago.

No friends or relations
On weekend vacations.

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That I, I above all, am chosen – even I
Must find that strange. I who was always
Disobedient, rebellious – smoked in the dining car,
Wore rouge when he said we mustn't.
When he ordered that poor Chancellor Schuschnigg
Was to starve, I sent in food.

We won't have it know, dear,
That we own a telephone, dear.

I who joined the Party, I who took Him
For my lover just to spite my old stiff father –
Den Alten Fritz! – and those stupid nuns.
I ran my teachers crazy, and my mother – I
Held out even when she stuck my head in water.
He shall have none but me.

Day will break
And you will wake

We cannot make it through another month;
We follow the battles now on a subway map.

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Even if the Russians pulled back --
His hand trembles, the whole left side
Staggers. His marvelous eyes are failing.
We go out to the sunlight less each day. We live
Like flies sucked up in a sweeper bag.

And start to bake
A sugar cake

He forbade me to leave Berchtesgaden,
Forbade me to come here. I tricked
My keepers, stole my own car, my driver Jung.
He tried to scold me; He was too
Proud of me. Today He ordered me to leave,
To go back to the mountain. I refused.
I have refused to save my own life and He,
In public, He kissed me on the mouth.

For me to take
For all the boys to see.

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Once more I have won, won out over Him

Who spoke one word and whole populations vanished.

Until today, in public, we were good friends.

He is mine. No doubt

I did only what He wanted; no doubt

I should resent that. In the face

Of such fulfillment? In the face

Of so much joy?

Picture you
Upon my knee;
Tea for two
And two for tea . . . .

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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